# Zaid Daghash

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**Portfolio:** https://zaid1201.github.io/portfolio/ **GitHub:** https://github.com/Zaid1201?tab=repositories

## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Jordanian national born and raised in Qatar, holding a First-Class Honours BEng in Computer Systems Engineering from the University of Sheffield and an MSc in Cyber Security from Liverpool John Moores University (expected Distinction). CompTIA Security+ and Network+ certified, with practical experience in network security, security automation, SIEM, intrusion detection, embedded systems, and secure software development through academic projects, Capture the Flag competition, and independent technical work. Currently employed as a Maximo Operator/EAM Systems Engineer with the CHEC–ALCAT Joint Venture, gaining experience in enterprise systems, operational processes, and cross-functional collaboration within a large-scale infrastructure environment. A proactive and adaptable engineering graduate with strong analytical, technical, and problem-solving skills, committed to continuous learning and applying technology to solve complex real-world challenges.

## CERTIFICATIONS

**CompTIA: Security+, Network+**

**UPDA/MMUP Engineer Registration**

## COMPETITIONS

### Capture The Flag (CTF) – National Cyber Security Agency (NCSA)

*Nov 2025*

*Rosewood Doha Hotel | Qatar*

## KEY PROJECTS

### Offensive & Defensive Security Engineer Simulation: Penetration Testing and IDS Deployment

- Executed 5 distinct attacks (SSH brute-force, RCE on Drupal/LotusCMS, kernel privilege escalation, and Tomcat WAR deployment) against a target server using Kali Linux and Metasploit.
- Analyzed network traffic in Wireshark to extract attack signatures and created 5 custom Suricata rules to detect them. Identified a post-exploitation attack that cannot be detected by a network-based IDS, justifying the need for HIDS/EDR solutions.
- Configured Splunk to ingest server logs (auth.log, access.log) and formulated precise queries to pinpoint attack patterns (e.g., brute-force traffic, malicious web requests), effectively hunting for adversarial activity.

### MSc Thesis: Adversarial Security Evaluation & Mitigation of Locally Deployed LLMs

- Developed an automated Python-based LLM security testing framework to evaluate 5 open-source models across 17 attack categories using 400 adversarial prompts and 4,000 API calls under regular and LLM-enhanced conditions.
- Performed quantitative and qualitative security analysis, including attack success rate (ASR), severity scoring, statistical testing, refusal-style classification and partial-compliance analysis, identifying significant differences in model vulnerability.
- Designed and implemented a tunable output filter using learned unigram/bigram patterns, achieving 53–100% ASR reduction with an 8% false-positive rate, and validated its real-time effectiveness through live LM Studio API testing.

### Security Automation Tool

- Developed a Python SOAR utility to enrich IOC indicators via public APIs and generate triage reports.
- Automated noisy alert filtering and produced CSV/JSON summaries to speed SOC investigation workflows.

### File Encryption & Security Tool

- Developed a Java-based GUI application that enables users to scan directories, view file metadata, and perform AES-256 encryption and decryption on files and folders.
- Implemented secure folder encryption with user-defined passwords and file integrity verification using SHA-256 hashing, with all actions logged automatically to a text file.

## EDUCATION

### Master of Science (MSc), Cyber Security

*Sep 2025 – Sep 2026*

*Liverpool John Moores University – Oryx University | Qatar*

- **Relevant modules include:** Computer Security, Network Security, Information Security Management, Ethical Hacking, Secure Systems

### Bachelor of Engineering (BEng), Computer Systems Engineering

*Sep 2021 – Jun 2024*

*The University of Sheffield | United Kingdom | First Class Honours (GPA: 4.0)*

- **Relevant modules include:** Introduction to Electric & Electronic Circuits, Digital Signal Processing, Mechatronics, Introduction to Systems Engineering & Software, Systems Engineering and Object-Oriented Programming, Computer Problem Solving and Object-Oriented Design, Systems Design and Security, Machine Learning, Computer Security and Forensics, Reinforcement Learning.

## SKILLS

- **Cybersecurity Tools:** Wireshark, Nmap, Metasploit, Nessus, Splunk
- **OS:** Windows, Linux
- **Programming Languages:** Python, Java, C, MATLAB
- **Microsoft Tools:** Word, Excel, PowerPoint
- **Core Skills:** Analytical | Problem-Solving | Project Leadership | Cross-functional Collaboration | Adaptability | Communication
- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Arabic (Native)

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### IBM Maximo Operator/EAM Systems Engineer

*Jul 2026 - Present*

*China Harbour Engineering Company Ltd. (CHEC & ALCAT JV) | Qatar*

- Developed a Python desktop automation tool to populate proposed QF values and justifications in IBM Maximo from Excel, using Windows UI Automation and OCR to match breach records, validate entries, and verify field values before manual saving.
- Developed a Python application to consolidate subcontractor patrol diaries into standardized JV-branded PowerPoint reports, with duplicate removal, record validation, and integrated review and approval, followed by automated PDF export, merging, compression, and email dispatch.
- Developed an automated notification workflow to alert responsible departments of open Work Orders approaching their SLA breach thresholds.
- Developed a Python desktop application for PDF merging, batch compression through the iLovePDF API, and image-to-PDF conversion, with configurable compression levels and file-size reduction reporting to streamline document preparation.
- Developed a Python compliance monitoring application to analyze IBM Maximo Work Order and Service Request exports, using reference data, historical patterns, and fuzzy matching to flag asset, classification, SLA, engineer-assignment, and work-log discrepancies through an interactive dashboard and Excel reports.
- Developed a Python file-processing tool to standardize filenames by record ID, remove duplicates, and convert Word documents to PDF, producing organized ZIP archives with preview controls, conversion recovery, and audit logs while preserving original files.
- Monitor Work Orders and Service Requests in IBM Maximo, assess compliance with contractual SLAs, and identify breached and approaching-breach cases for timely follow-up.
- Prepare operational Work Order and Service Request reports, including SLA-performance summaries for project management and relevant engineering disciplines.
- Coordinate with engineering, maintenance, and departmental representatives to verify data accuracy and support the timely closure of outstanding Work Orders.